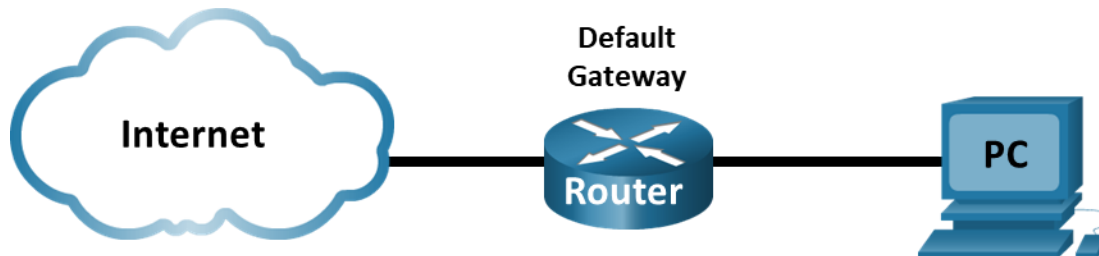


Lab 2 - Use Wireshark to Examine Ethernet Frames Topology



Objectives

Part 1: Examine the Header Fields in an Ethernet II Frame

Part 2: Use Wireshark to Capture and Analyze Ethernet Frames

Background / Scenario

When upper layer protocols communicate with each other, data flows down the Open Systems Interconnection (OSI) layers and is encapsulated into a Layer 2 frame. The frame composition is dependent on the media access type. For example, if the upper layer protocols are TCP and IP and the media access is Ethernet, then the Layer 2 frame encapsulation will be Ethernet II. This is typical for a LAN environment.

When learning about Layer 2 concepts, it is helpful to analyze frame header information. In the first part of this lab, you will review the fields contained in an Ethernet II frame. In Part 2, you will use Wireshark to capture and analyze Ethernet II frame header fields for local and remote traffic.

Required Resources

- 1 Workstation with Wireshark installed

Pre-lab

What is a hash function and what is it used for?

It is a cryptographic math function that fingerprints a stream of bits. It is used to determine uniqueness in of a stream of bits and to see if any bits have changed.

What is a packet capture?

It is the network stream saved to a file. It can be analyzed to troubleshoot network issues and study network traffic.

Instructions

Part 1: Examine the Header Fields in an Ethernet II Frame

In Part 1, you will examine the header fields and content in an Ethernet II frame. A Wireshark capture will be used to examine the contents in those fields.

Step 1: Review the Ethernet II header field descriptions and lengths.

Preamble	Destination Address	Source Address	Frame Type	Data	FCS
8 Bytes	6 Bytes	6 Bytes	2 Bytes	46 – 1500 Bytes	4 Bytes

Step 2: Examine the network configuration of the workstation.

Right-click on the Desktop and select Open in Terminal to get a Windows command prompt.

In this example, this workstation host IP address is 192.168.1.147 and the default gateway has an IP address of 192.168.1.1.

In Windows

```
C:\> ipconfig /all

Ethernet adapter Ethernet:

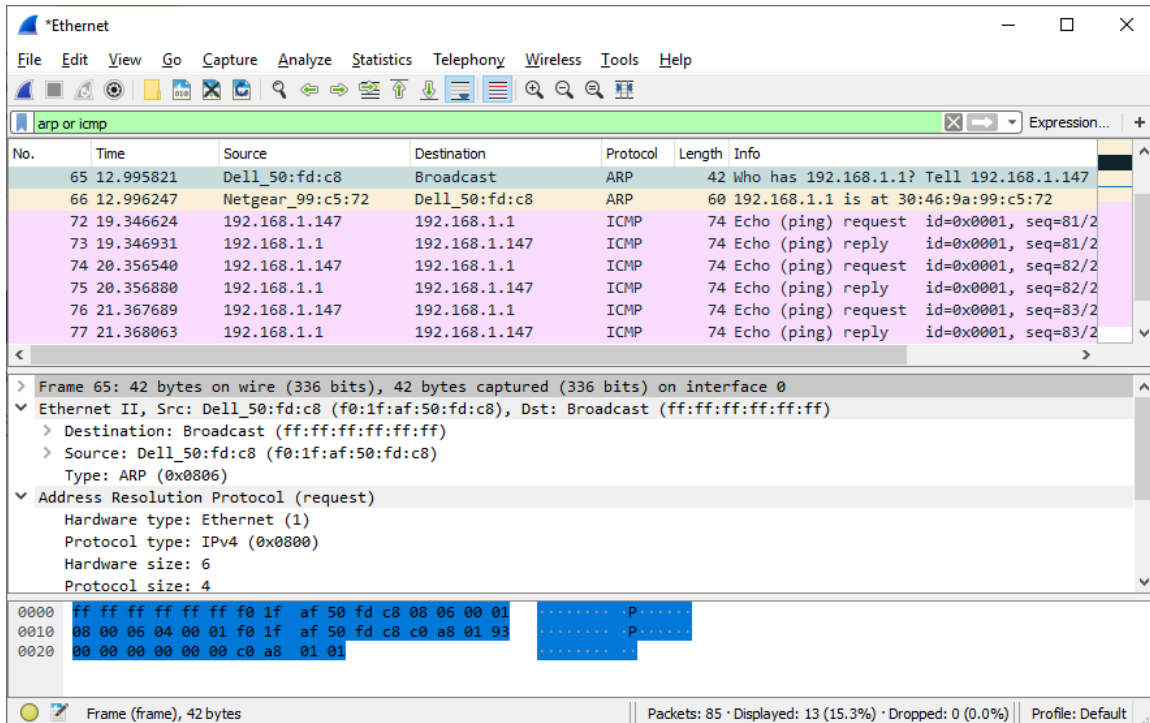
    Connection-specific DNS Suffix  . : 
    Description . . . . . : Intel(R) 82579LM Gigabit Network Connection
    Physical Address. . . . . : F0-1F-AF-50-FD-C8
    DHCP Enabled. . . . . : Yes
    Autoconfiguration Enabled . . . . : Yes
    Link-local IPv6 Address . . . . . : fe80::58c5:45f2:7e5e:29c2%11(Preferred)
    IPv4 Address. . . . . : 192.168.1.147(Preferred)
    Subnet Mask . . . . . : 255.255.255.0
    Lease Obtained. . . . . : Friday, September 6, 2019 11:08:36 AM
    Lease Expires . . . . . : Saturday, September 7, 2019 11:08:36 AM
    Default Gateway . . . . . : 192.168.1.1
    DHCP Server . . . . . : 192.168.1.1
    <output omitted>
```

Step 3: Examine Ethernet frames in a Wireshark capture.

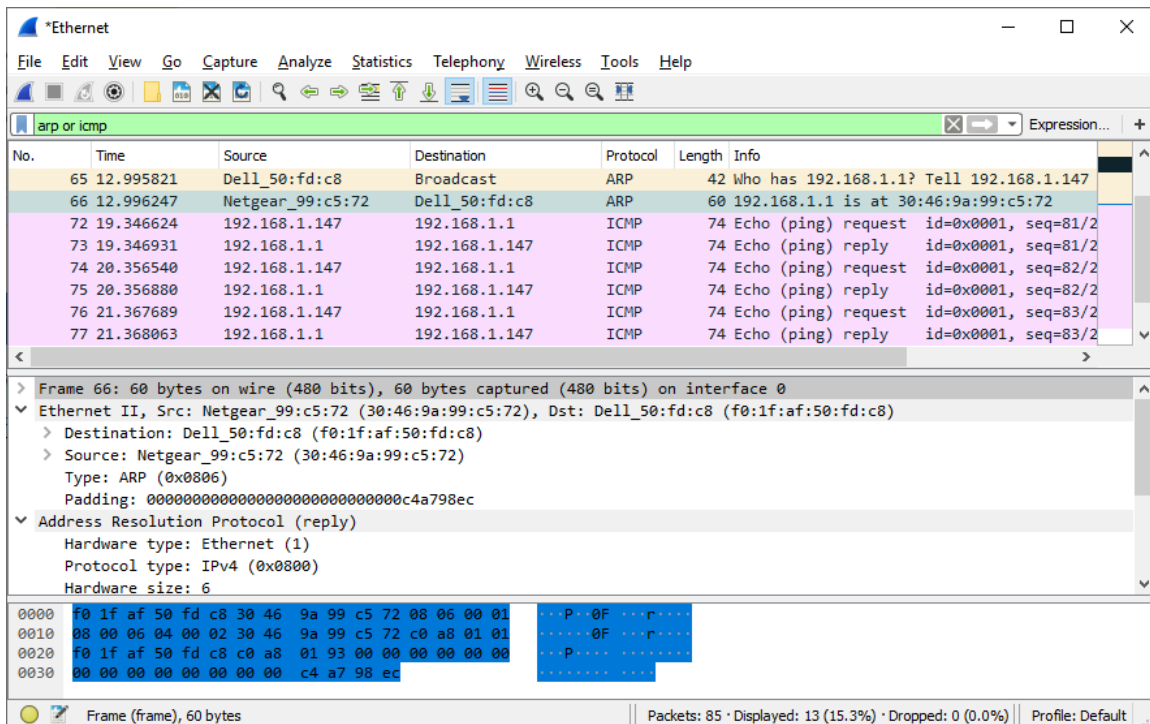
The screenshots of the Wireshark capture below shows the packets generated by a ping being issued from a PC host to its default gateway. A filter has been applied to Wireshark to view the ARP and ICMP protocols only. ARP stands for address resolution protocol. ARP is a communication protocol that is used for determining the MAC address that is associated with the IP address. The session begins with an ARP query and reply for the MAC address of the gateway router, followed by four ping requests and replies.

Lab - Use Wireshark to Examine Ethernet Frames

This screenshot highlights the frame details for an ARP request.



This screenshot highlights the frame details for an ARP reply.



Step 4: Examine the Ethernet II header contents of an ARP request.

The following table takes the first frame in the Wireshark capture and displays the data in the Ethernet II header fields.

Field	Value	Description						
Preamble	Not shown in capture	This field contains synchronizing bits, processed by the NIC hardware.						
Destination Address	Broadcast (ff:ff:ff:ff:ff:ff)	Layer 2 addresses for the frame. Each address is 48 bits long, or 6 octets, expressed as 12 hexadecimal digits, 0–9, A–F. A common format is 12:34:56:78:9A:BC.						
Source Address	Dell_50:fd:c8 (f0:1f:af:50:fd:c8)	The first six hex numbers indicate the manufacturer of the network interface card (NIC), the last six hex numbers are the serial number of the NIC. The destination address may be a broadcast, which contains all ones, or a unicast. The source address is always unicast.						
Frame Type	0x0806	For Ethernet II frames, this field contains a hexadecimal value that is used to indicate the type of upper-layer protocol in the data field. There are numerous upper-layer protocols supported by Ethernet II. Two common frame types are these: <table><tr><td>Value</td><td>Description</td></tr><tr><td>0x0800</td><td>IPv4 Protocol</td></tr><tr><td>0x0806</td><td>Address Resolution Protocol (ARP)</td></tr></table>	Value	Description	0x0800	IPv4 Protocol	0x0806	Address Resolution Protocol (ARP)
Value	Description							
0x0800	IPv4 Protocol							
0x0806	Address Resolution Protocol (ARP)							
Data	ARP	Contains the encapsulated upper-level protocol. The data field is between 46 – 1,500 bytes.						
FCS	Not shown in capture	Frame Check Sequence, used by the NIC to identify errors during transmission. The value is computed by the sending device, encompassing frame addresses, type, and data field. It is verified by the receiver.						

What is significant about the contents of the destination address field?

Broadcast (ff:ff:ff:ff:ff:ff). The destination address ff:ff:ff:ff:ff:ff is a Layer 2 broadcast address, meaning the Ethernet frame is sent to every device on the local network segment.

Why does the PC send out a broadcast ARP prior to sending the first ping request?

To find the destination device's MAC address

What is the MAC address of the source in the first frame?

f0:1f:af:50:fd:c8.

What is the Vendor ID (OUI) of the Source NIC in the ARP reply?

Netgear_ (30:46:9a)

What portion of the MAC address is the OUI?

the first 3 octets (or the first 6 hexadecimal digits / 24 bits) of a MAC address

What is the NIC serial number of the source?

the last 3 octets / remaining 6 hexadecimal digits

Part 2: Use Wireshark to Capture and Analyze Ethernet Frames

In Part 2, you will use Wireshark to capture local and remote Ethernet frames. You will then examine the information that is contained in the frame header fields.

Step 1: Determine the IP address of the default gateway on your PC.

Open a command prompt window and issue the **ipconfig** command.

What is the IP address of the PC default gateway?

10.130.0.1

Step 2: Start capturing traffic on your PC NIC.

- Open Wireshark to start data capture.
- Observe the traffic that appears in the packet list window.

Step 3: Filter Wireshark to display only ICMP traffic.

You can use the filter in Wireshark to block visibility of unwanted traffic. The filter does not block the capture of unwanted data; it only filters what you want to display on the screen. For now, only ICMP traffic is to be displayed.

In the Wireshark **Filter** box, type **icmp**. The box should turn green if you typed the filter correctly. If the box is green, click **Apply** (the right arrow) to apply the filter.

Step 4: From the command prompt window, ping the default gateway of your PC.

From the command window, ping the default gateway using the IP address that you recorded in Step 1.

Step 5: Stop capturing traffic on the NIC.

Click the **Stop Capturing Packets** icon to stop capturing traffic.

Step 6: Examine the first Echo (ping) request in Wireshark.

The Wireshark main window is divided into three sections: the packet list pane (top), the **Packet Details** pane (middle), and the **Packet Bytes** pane (bottom). If you selected the correct interface for packet capturing previously, Wireshark should display the ICMP information in the packet list pane of Wireshark.

- In the packet list pane (top section), click the first frame listed. You should see **Echo (ping) request** under the **Info** heading. The line should now be highlighted.
- Examine the first line in the packet details pane (middle section). This line displays the length of the frame.
- The second line in the packet details pane shows that it is an Ethernet II frame. The source and destination MAC addresses are also displayed.

What is the MAC address of the PC NIC?
--

00:50:56:84:aa:c3

What is the default gateway's MAC address?
--

b4:0c:25:e6:80:01

- You can click the greater than (>) sign at the beginning of the second line to obtain more information about the Ethernet II frame.

What type of frame is displayed?

0x800 = IPV4

- The last two lines displayed in the middle section provide information about the data field of the frame. Notice that the data contains the source and destination IPv4 address information.

What is the source IP address?

10.130.2.110

What is the destination IP address?

10.130.0.1

- f. You can click any line in the middle section to highlight that part of the frame (hex and ASCII) in the **Packet Bytes** pane (bottom section). Click the **Internet Control Message Protocol** line in the middle section and examine what is highlighted in the **Packet Bytes** pane.

What do the last two highlighted octets spell?
--

hi

- g. Click the next frame in the top section and examine an Echo reply frame. Notice that the source and destination MAC addresses have reversed, because this frame was sent from the default gateway router as a reply to the first ping.

What device and MAC address is displayed as the destination address?
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The PC NIC with the MAC address 00:50:56:84:aa:c3

Step 7: Capture packets for a remote host.

- Click the **Start Capture** icon to start a new Wireshark capture. You will receive a popup window asking if you would like to save the previous captured packets to a file before starting a new capture. Click **Continue without Saving**.
- In a command prompt window, ping www.cisco.com.
- Stop capturing packets.
- Examine the new data in the packet list pane of Wireshark.

In the first echo (ping) request frame, what are the source and destination MAC addresses?
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Source: 00:50:56:84:aa:c3

Destination: b4:0c:25:e6:80:01

What are the source and destination IP addresses contained in the data field of the frame?

Source:10.130.2.110

Destination:23.37.18.125

Compare these addresses to the addresses you received in Step 6. The only address that changed is the destination IP address.

Why has the destination IP address changed, while the destination MAC address remained the same?

The destination IP address changes because the ping is sent to a remote host, www.cisco.com, instead of the local default gateway. The destination MAC address remains the same because the Ethernet frame is sent to the default gateway, which forwards the packet toward the remote destination.

Step 8: Save a forensic image.

- In Wireshark's File menu, click the Save As option to save the packet capture content to a file in the current user's Documents folder.
- In the File Explorer application, right-click on the Documents folder and select Open in Terminal.
- In the command prompt, run `Get-FileHash` on the packet capture file.
- In the command prompt, run `Get-FileHash -Algorithm MD5` on the packet capture file.

Record the hash values.

SHA256: 565B327BCA848CA364C6C515C62F6716B9287408F015AE45D059E31FBCBCBE62
MD5:FD2134A78E93EEAC0F34191C8149013C

Reflection Questions

Wireshark does not display the preamble field of a frame header.

What does the preamble contain?

The Ethernet preamble contains a specific 7-byte alternating pattern of 1s and 0s (10101010 repeated seven times) followed by a 1-byte Start Frame Delimiter (SFD) ending in two 1s (10101011).

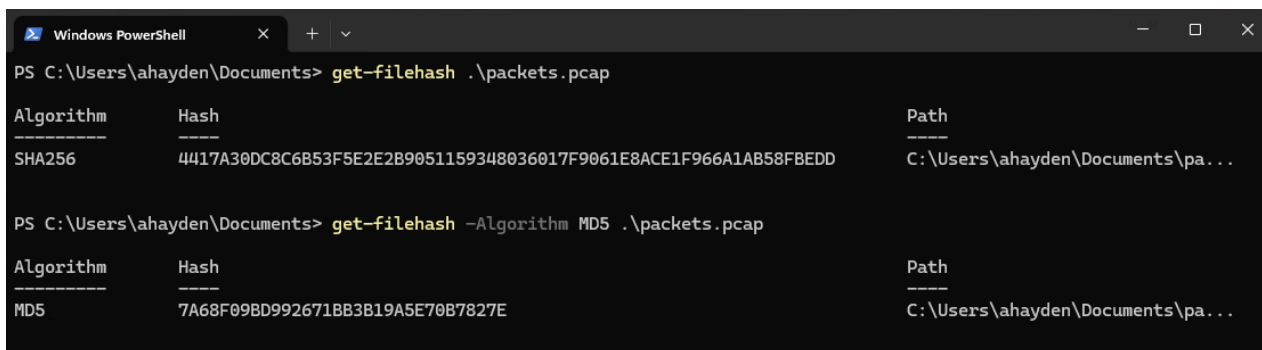
Explain three differences between ARP and ICMP.

ARP is used to discover the MAC address associated with an IPv4 address on the local network, while ICMP is used for network diagnostics and error reporting. ARP requests use local Ethernet broadcasts and are not forwarded by routers, while ICMP messages are carried inside IP packets and can travel across routers. ARP helps devices deliver frames on a local network, whereas ICMP supports tools such as ping to test connectivity.

How is a MAC address different from an IP address?

A MAC address is typically a 48-bit address used to identify a network interface on a local network. An IP address is a logical address used to identify a device's network location. IPv4 addresses are 32 bits, while IPv6 addresses are 128 bits. MAC addresses can be changed or randomized, and IP addresses can be assigned manually or dynamically.

The screenshot below shows hash values recorded by the instructor. Do you get the same hashes? How are these hash values useful in a forensic investigation?



```
Windows PowerShell
PS C:\Users\ahayden\Documents> get-filehash .\packets.pcap

Algorithm      Hash
-----
SHA256         4417A30DC8C6B53F5E2E2B9051159348036017F9061E8ACE1F966A1AB58FBEDD
Path           C:\Users\ahayden\Documents\pa...

PS C:\Users\ahayden\Documents> get-filehash -Algorithm MD5 .\packets.pcap

Algorithm      Hash
-----
MD5            7A68F09BD992671BB3B19A5E70B7827E
Path           C:\Users\ahayden\Documents\pa...
```

My hashes are different from the ones above. Hash values act as digital fingerprints for files, making them important in forensic investigations for proving data integrity and identifying known files.